Brand Engagement Diagnostic

Rebuilding Trust & Engagement with Gen Z on social media

Brands: Dior (Primary)|Gucci Versace
Platforms: TikTok & Instagram
Time Scope: Longitudinal (3-year directional analysis: 2023–2025)

1. Purpose of the Engagement Audit (Why This Scope Matters)

This engagement audit evaluates three years of social media performance across Dior, Gucci, and Versace to diagnose where and why engagement with Gen Z is weakening. A longitudinal scope is critical because Gen Z engagement patterns fluctuate rapidly and cannot be accurately understood through isolated posts or short-term performance. Evaluating trends over time allows patterns in reach, interaction, and audience behavior to emerge, revealing structural engagement issues rather than temporary content performance anomalies.

Rather than treating social media as static snapshots, this analysis adopts a non-linear diagnostic approach, recognizing that engagement outcomes are influenced by brand authority, platform behavior, cultural relevance, and shifting audience expectations operating simultaneously.

While select engagement metrics reflect recent platform snapshots, they are used as directional indicators to support longitudinal trend analysis rather than point-in-time performance.

2. Brand Context & Positioning

All three brands operate within the luxury fashion segment, competing for cultural relevance, aspiration, and attention among Gen Z audiences.

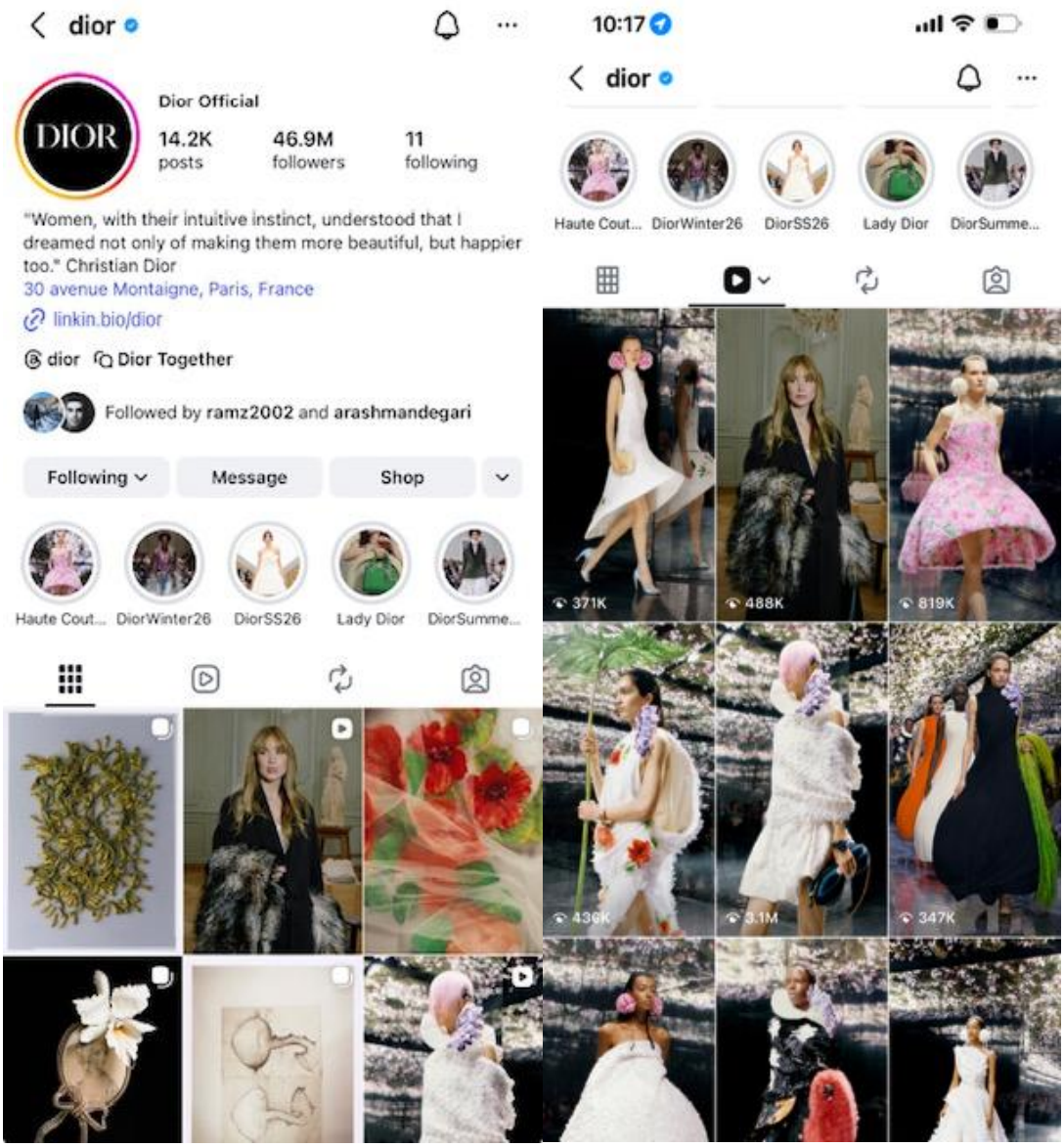
- **Dior** positions itself as a heritage authority rooted in couture, craftsmanship, and artistic legacy.
- **Gucci** positions itself as a fashion disruptor with strong cultural experimentation and celebrity integration.

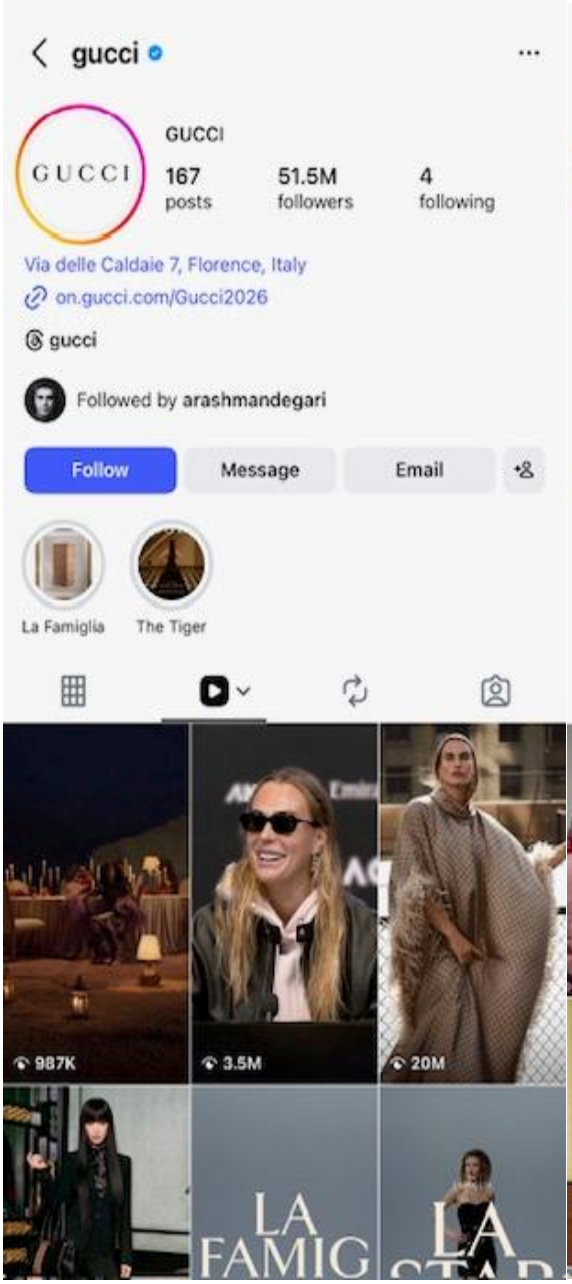
- **Versace** positions itself as a bold, product-driven luxury brand emphasizing lifestyle and visual impact.

While these positioning strategies have historically supported brand equity, Gen Z engagement data suggests increasing tension between traditional luxury storytelling and platform-native social interaction.

3. Engagement Evidence: Account-Level Comparison

Instagram screenshots

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167 posts
51.5M followers
4 following
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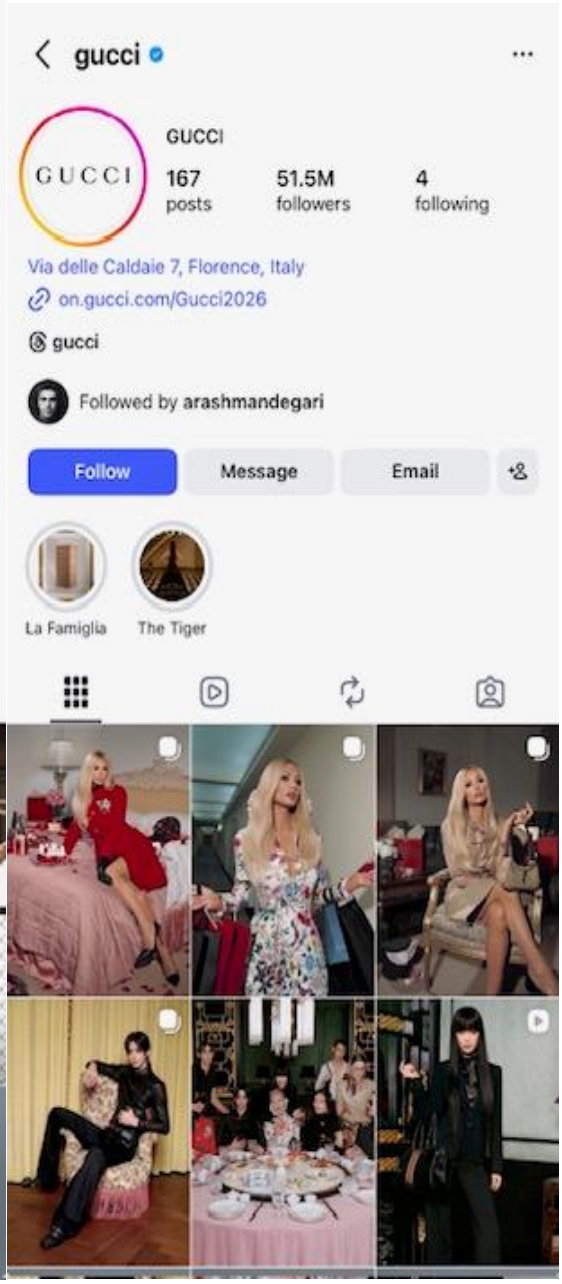
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The Tiger

versace

VERSACE

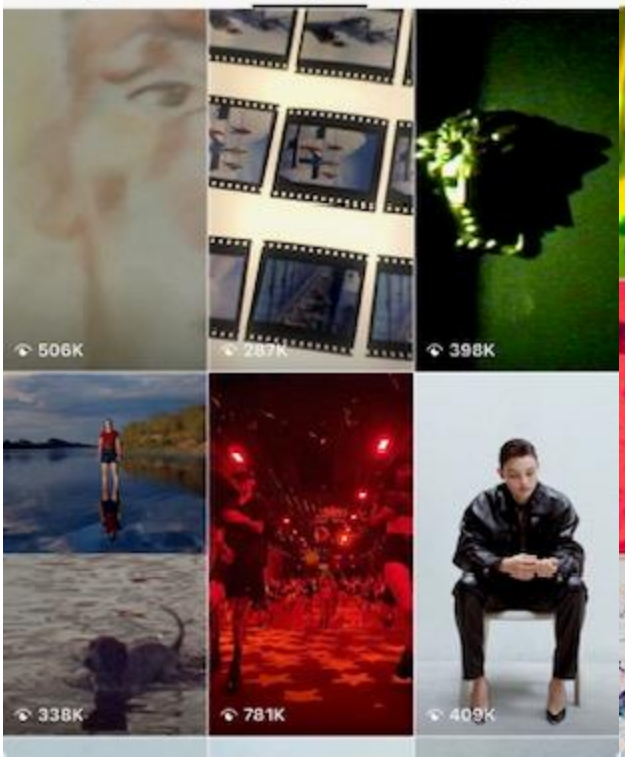
124 posts | 29.3M followers | 2 following

Design & fashion

e-versace.com/bio

Followed by ben_saad_ala and arashmandegari

Follow | Message | Shop



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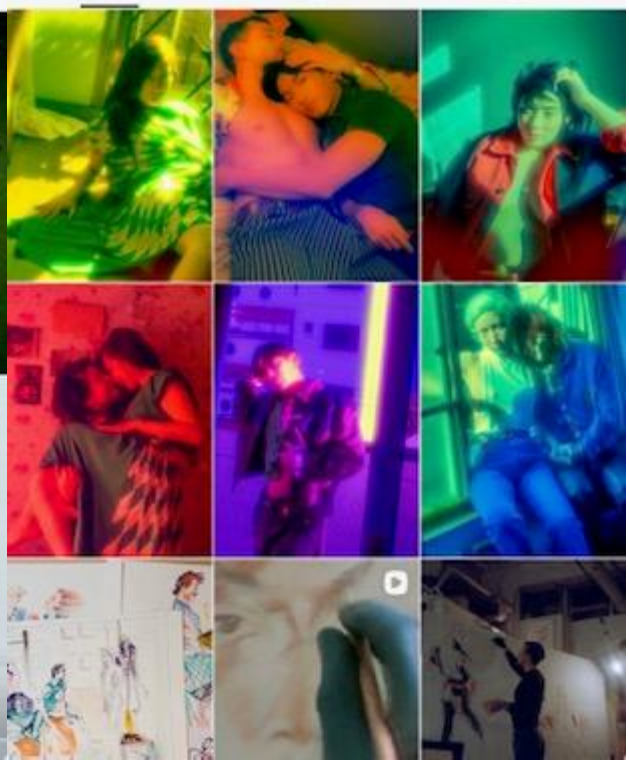
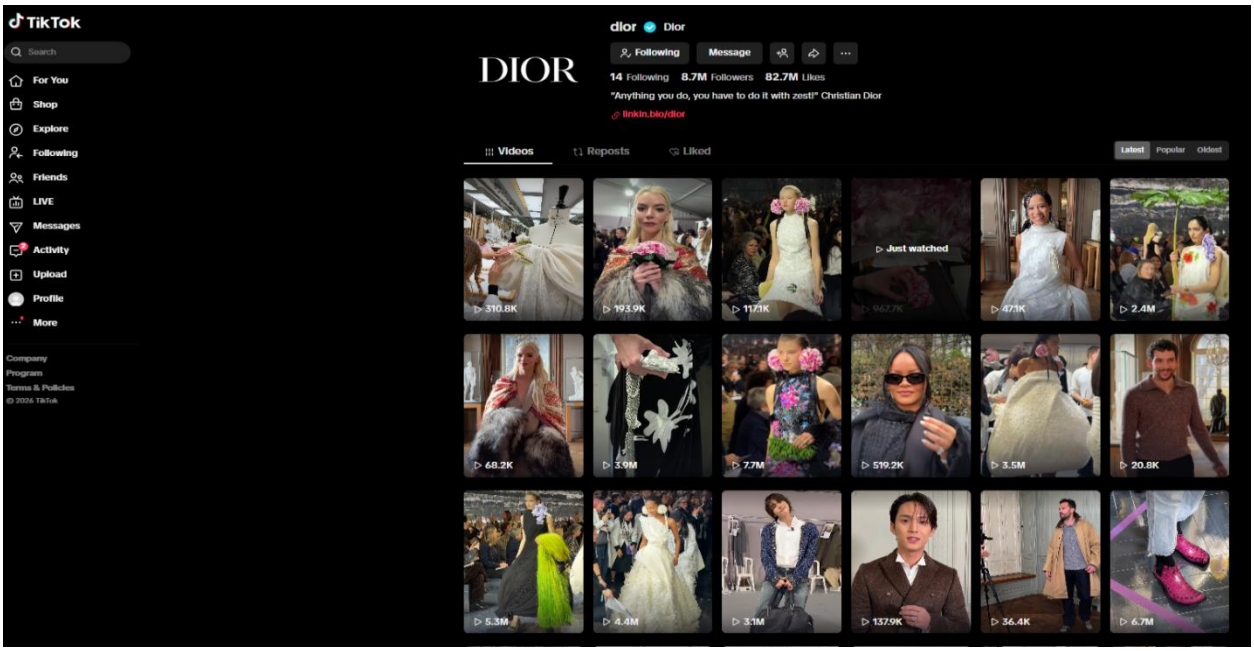
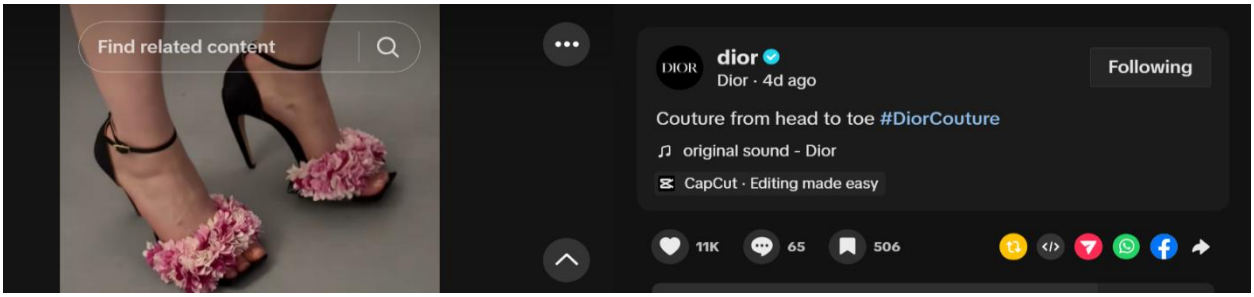
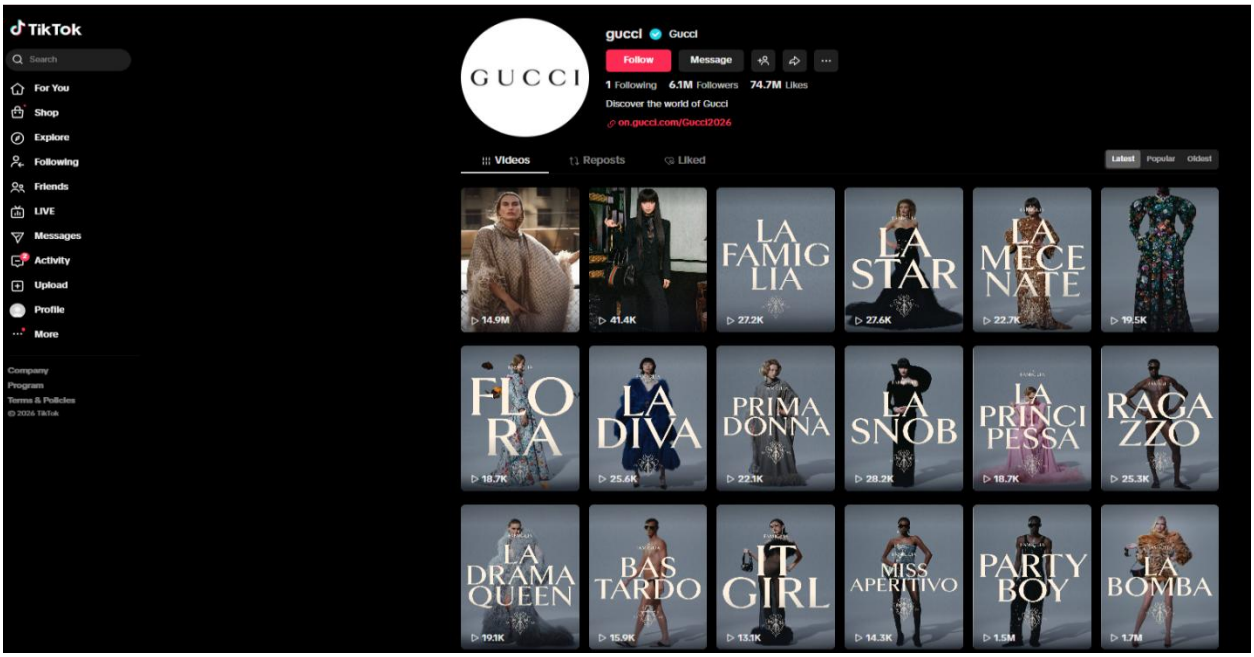
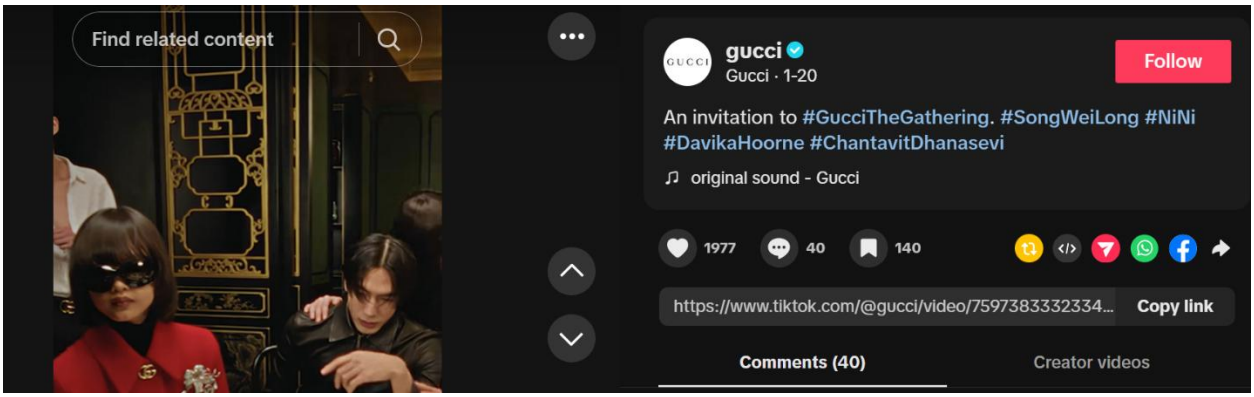


TikTok screenshots





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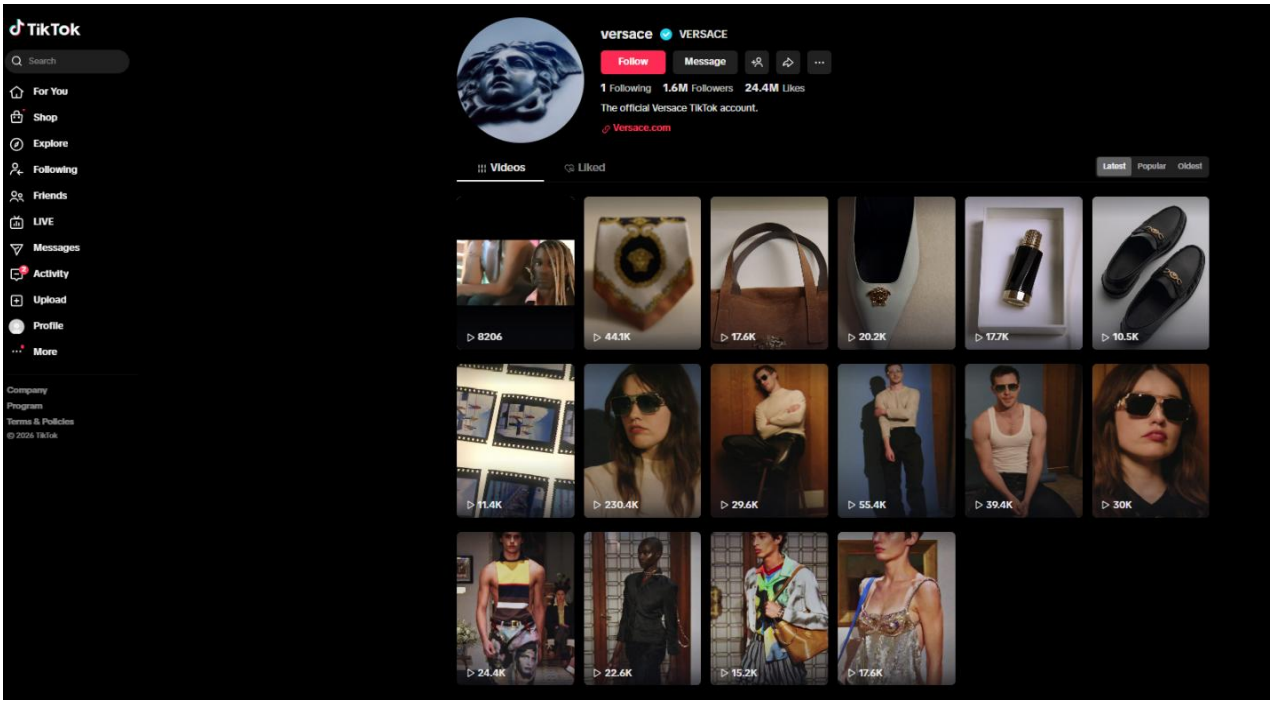
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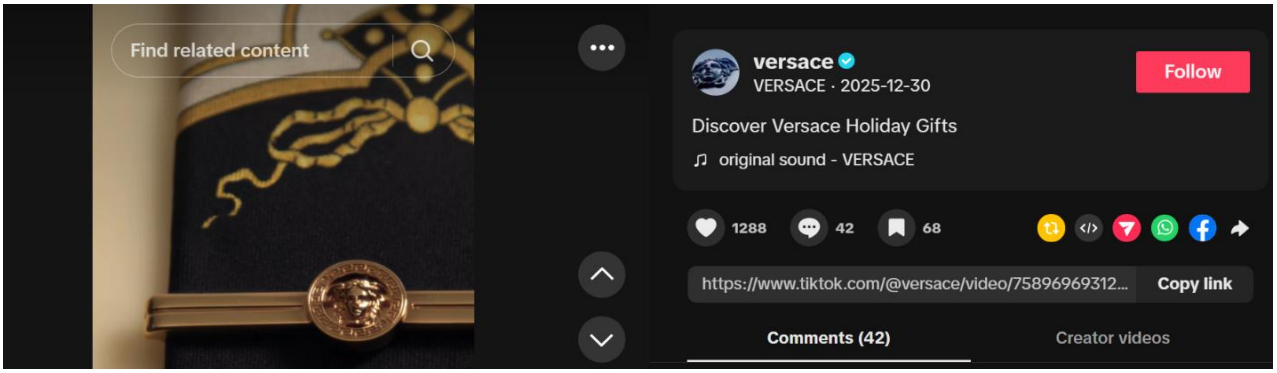
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TikTok Account Metrics (Observed)

Brand	Followers	Total Likes	Following
Dior	8.7M	82.7M	14
Gucci	6.1M	74.7M	1
Versace	1.6M	24.4M	1

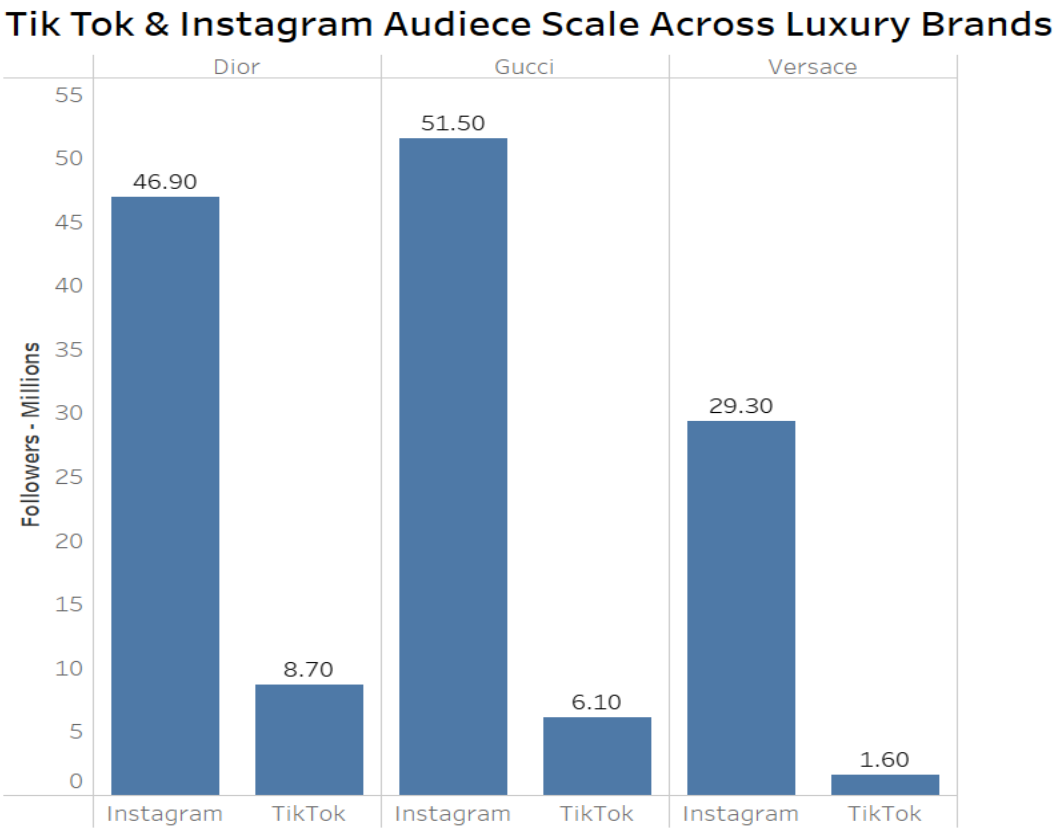
Insight:
All three brands demonstrate strong reach and visibility on TikTok, indicating that awareness is not the limiting factor. However, follower scale does not consistently translate into proportional interaction, signaling potential engagement inefficiencies.

Instagram Account Metrics (Observed)

Brand	Followers	Posts	Following
Dior	46.9M	14.2K	11
Gucci	51.5M	167	4
Versace	29.3M	124	2

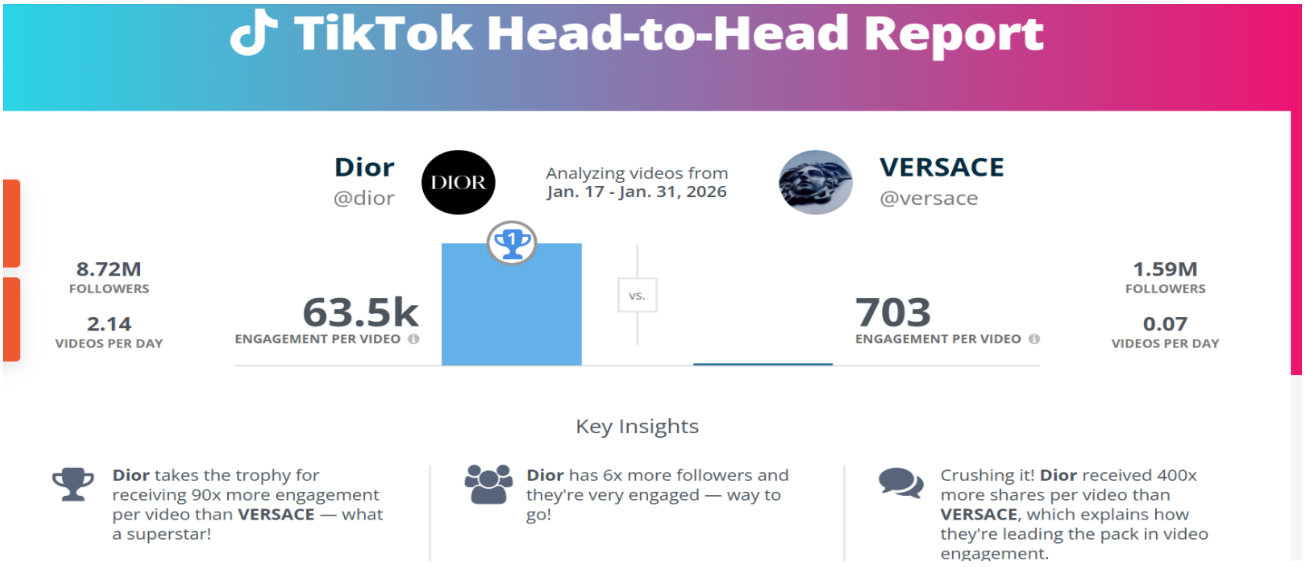
Insight:
Instagram remains a scale-dominant platform for all three brands. However, high follower counts coexist with uneven engagement intensity, particularly among Gen Z users who increasingly favor participatory formats over editorial presentation.

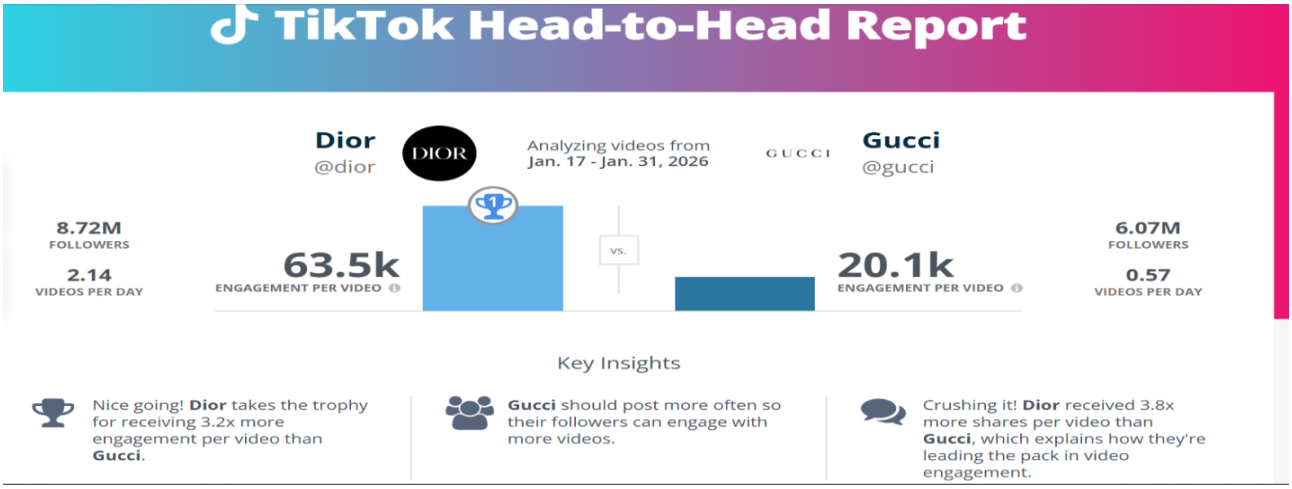
The following visual compares TikTok and Instagram audience scale across Dior, Gucci, and Versace.

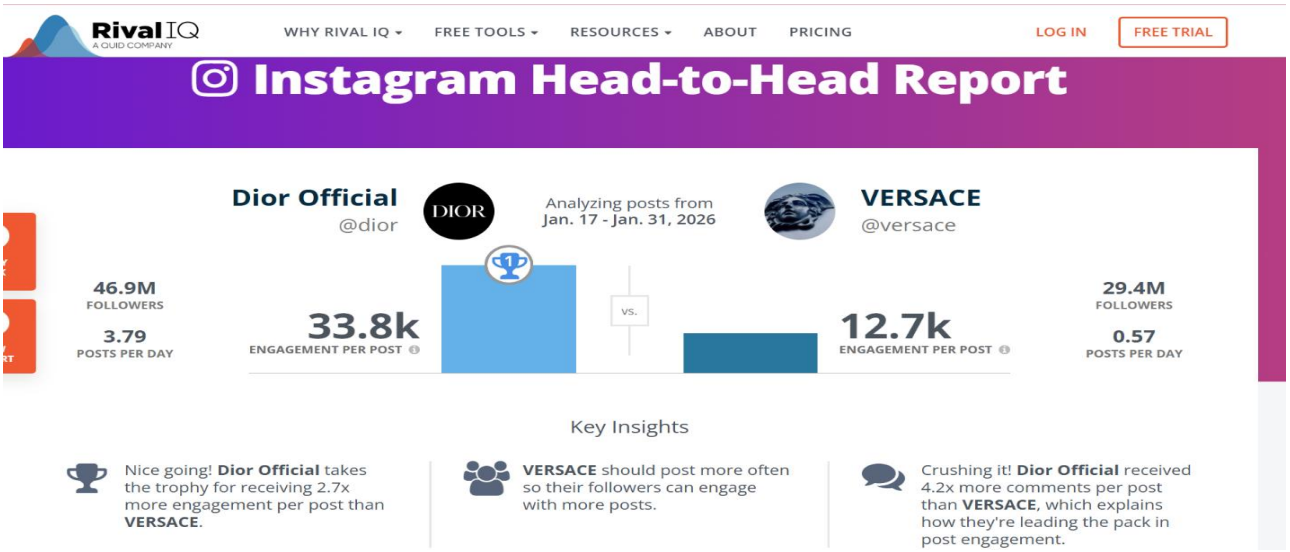


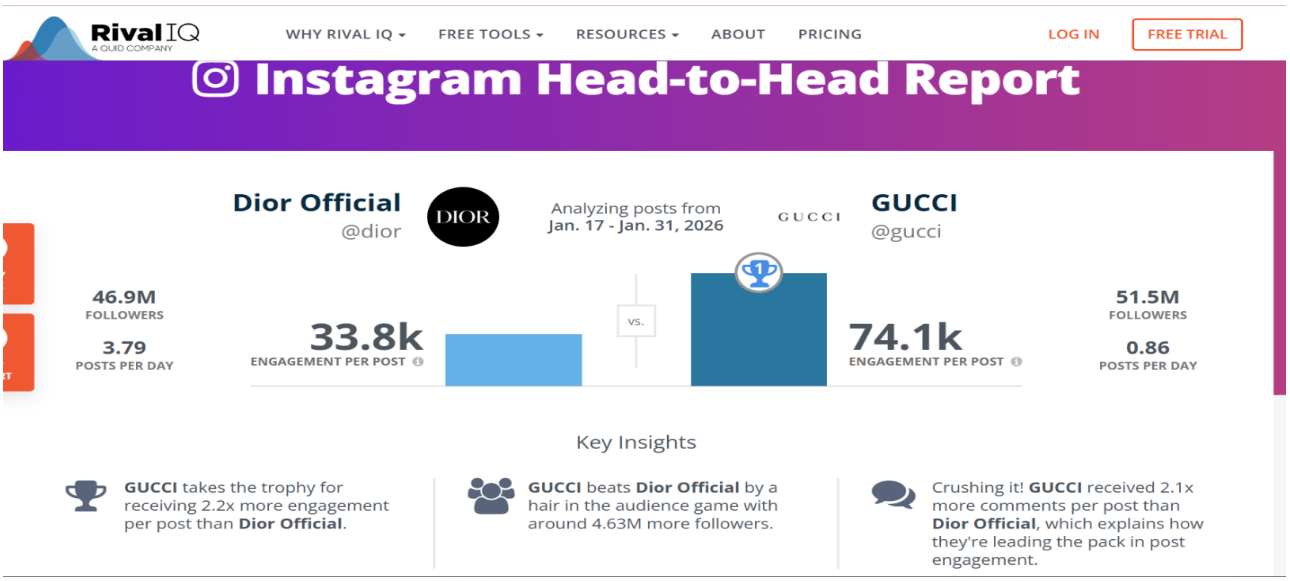
Despite large follower bases, audience scale alone does not explain Gen Z engagement behavior.

4. Posting Frequency & Engagement Intensity Comparison





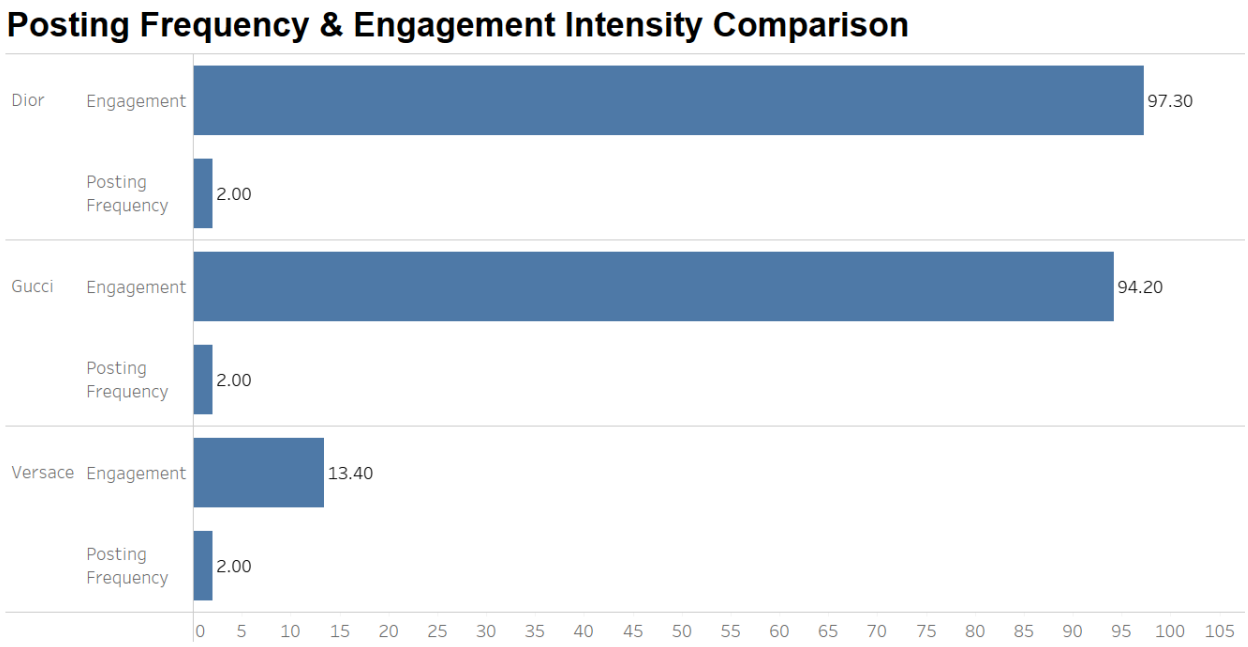




Data Source: Rival IQ Head-to-Head Reports (Instagram & TikTok)

Platform	Brand	Followers (Millions)	Posts/Videos per Day	Engagement per Post/Video (Thousands)
Instagram	Dior	46.9	3.79	33.8
Instagram	Gucci	51.5	0.86	74.1
Instagram	Versace	29.4	0.57	12.7
TikTok	Dior	8.72	2.14	63.5
TikTok	Gucci	6.07	0.57	20.1
TikTok	Versace	1.59	0.07	0.703

Higher posting frequency does not consistently translate into higher engagement, indicating that Gen Z interaction is driven more by content resonance than volume.



A comparison of posting frequency and engagement intensity across Instagram and TikTok shows that higher content volume does not linearly result in stronger engagement outcomes. While Dior posts more frequently than both Gucci and Versace on both platforms, engagement per post varies significantly by brand and platform. Gucci achieves higher engagement per Instagram post despite a lower posting frequency, while Dior dominates engagement per video on TikTok even as Versace posts far less frequently. This pattern suggests that Gen Z engagement is shaped less by how often brands publish content and more by how effectively content aligns with platform norms, cultural relevance, and audience expectations.

5. Post-Level Engagement Patterns (TikTok Evidence)

Dior

- Multiple videos reach millions of views, especially runway, couture, and craftsmanship content.
- Engagement (likes, comments, saves) is concentrated around visually striking moments rather than consistently distributed.
- Interaction levels do not scale proportionally with views across most posts.

Gucci

- Performance is highly volatile.
- Selecting celebrity or campaign-driven posts generates large spikes in views, while many editorial fashion clips remain in the tens of thousands.
- Engagement is event-dependent rather than rhythm-based.

Versace

- Lower overall reach but more stable engagement ratios.
- Product-focused and lifestyle content generates modest yet consistent interaction.
- Engagement appears more transactional than cultural.

High view counts increasingly represent passive consumption, not active engagement. This suggests that Gen Z audiences are watching luxury content but are less inclined to interact unless content feels participatory, authentic, or socially embedded.

6. Diagnostic Interpretation

The engagement challenge across Dior, Gucci, and Versace is not driven by a single failure but by interacting forces:

- Brand authority vs. platform behavior
- Heritage storytelling vs. cultural participation
- Visual perfection vs. social authenticity

These forces operate simultaneously, producing outcomes where reach remains high while engagement depth weakens. This non-linear dynamic explains why increasing content volume or production quality does not automatically improve Gen Z interaction.

7. Key Findings

The engagement diagnostic reveals that Gen Z disengagement is not caused by declining brand interest, but by a growing mismatch between luxury brand communication models and social platform expectations. Dior, Gucci, and Versace continue to command attention; however, their content strategies increasingly function as broadcast media rather than social ecosystems.

This diagnostic establishes the foundation for identifying root causes and designing engagement recovery strategies, which are addressed in next step.

8. Key Learnings and Building a Path to Increased Engagement

Key Learnings (Indicators & Triggers)

The non-linear analysis of Dior's social media performance relative to Gucci and Versace shows that Dior's current engagement position is not the result of declining brand equity, but rather the outcome of how its authority-driven brand model interacts with Gen Z platform behavior. Dior continues to attract attention at scale, particularly through couture, runway, and craftsmanship content; however, engagement increasingly concentrates around spectacle rather than sustained interaction. This indicates a shift in how Gen Z consumes luxury content: admiration has replaced participation. Over time, Dior's emphasis on heritage signaling, visual perfection, and controlled storytelling has helped reinforce brand prestige, but has also reduced conversational intimacy. As Gen Z expectations evolved toward authenticity, co-creation, and cultural immediacy, Dior's content strategy did not adapt at the same pace, creating an engagement gap despite strong visibility.

Path to Increased Engagement (Strategic Actions)

To rebuild engagement with Gen Z, Dior must first redefine relevance not as cultural authority, but as cultural presence. The most critical step is shifting from a broadcast mindset to a participatory one, allowing Gen Z to feel included rather than addressed. This requires integrating platform-native behaviors such as creator collaboration, behind-the-scenes imperfection, and conversational storytelling that invites interaction rather than observation. Dior should rebalance its mixed content by pairing high-craft heritage moments with human-centered narratives that feel socially embedded and emotionally accessible. Over time, success will depend less on producing flawless visuals and more on signaling openness, responsiveness, and cultural fluency. By repositioning itself as a collaborator within Gen Z culture rather than a distant authority above it, Dior can rebuild trust and restore sustained engagement across social platforms.

Strategic Path Matrix

Building on the diagnostic findings from Step 1, this section shifts from analysis to strategic action. While Step 1 identified the key challenges affecting Dior's authenticity and relevance among Gen Z, Step 2 focuses on translating those insights into practical initiatives and measurable outcomes.

This stage develops a Strategic Path Matrix to connect root causes with targeted pivots and evaluation metrics. It further justifies selected initiatives and examines platform strategy through video analysis and social media usage data.

Together, this section outlines how Dior can move from understanding its positioning challenges to implementing data supported strategies that strengthen engagement and authenticity with Gen Z audiences.

Phase	Dior	Gucci	Versace
1. Diagnostic	• Broadcast style authority model • Spectacle driven spikes, low sustained dialogue • Highly polished content limits authenticity	• Campaign/celebrity dependent spikes • Editorial content lacks engagement rhythm • Inconsistent community integration	• Product forward vs culture forward • Transactional engagement pattern • Limited platform native adaptation
2. Pivots	• Micro/nano creator collaborations • Behind the scenes humanized series • Interactive polls, duets, UGC prompts	• Weekly creator storytelling cadence • Community remix challenges • Comment led content iteration	• Narrative led styling journeys • Gen Z subculture collaborations • Direct community feedback channels
3. Analytics & Evaluation	• 10 – 15% Engagement rate growth • Duet/UGC participation increase • 10% repeat engager rate • Sentiment score improvement	• Reduced engagement volatility • Campaign vs non-campaign gap shrink • Weekly engagement consistency score	• Share to view ratio growth • Comment depth increase • Creator collab performance lift

Dior

1. Authority Driven Communication Model

Content operates as broadcast media rather than participatory social dialogue.

2. Spectacle Centered Engagement

Interaction spikes around runway/couture “visual moments” but does not translate into sustained conversational engagement.

3. Perfection Over Authenticity

Highly polished, controlled storytelling limits perceived intimacy with Gen Z audiences who value transparency and co creation.

Gucci

1. Event Dependent Engagement Volatility

Performance spikes during celebrity campaigns but lacks consistent engagement rhythm.

2. Reliance on Campaign Drops

Editorial fashion clips underperform unless tied to cultural moments.

3. Inconsistent Community Integration

Engagement is attention based rather than relationship based.

Versace

1. Lower Cultural Embedment

Content is product forward but less socially embedded within Gen Z culture.

2. Transactional Engagement Pattern

Interaction reflects consumption intent rather than participatory community behavior.

3. Limited Platform Native Adaptation

Content aesthetics do not fully align with TikTok’s participatory norms

Strategic Pivots

Dior

1. Creator Led Cultural Co Creation: Shift from celebrity showcases to micro/nano creator collaborations embedded in Gen Z communities (fashion students, stylists, digital artists). Addresses the authority driven broadcast gap.

2. Behind the Scenes Humanization Series: Launch recurring “Inside Dior” short form series showing imperfect, human, process driven moments. Addresses perfection over authenticity.

3. Interactive Social Mechanics: Introduce polls, Q&A drops, remixable sounds, and TikTok duet/stitch prompts to increase participatory depth. Addresses spectacle without sustained interaction.

Gucci

1. Engagement Rhythm Strategy: Move from event spikes to structured weekly creator storytelling cadence.

2. Community Activation Campaigns: Introduce user remix challenges tied to brand heritage.

3. Comment Led Content Iteration: Use comment analysis to influence next content wave.

Versace

1. Culture Led Narrative Shift: Shift from product display to narrative led styling journeys.

2. Gen Z Subculture Integration: Collaborate with niche fashion subcultures (digital fashion, sustainability creators).

3. Community Feedback Loop: Build direct conversational channels to reduce transactional tone.

Analytics & Evaluation

Dior

To evaluate the effectiveness of the proposed strategic pivots, the following key performance indicators (KPIs) will be monitored over a six month period.

1. Engagement Metrics

- Engagement Rate (likes, comments, shares, saves)- Target: 10–15% increase.

- Comment to View Ratio - Target: measurable upward trend indicating stronger conversational engagement.
- Save Rate - Target: steady growth, reflecting increased long term content value.

2. Participation Metrics

- Duet/Stitch Participation (TikTok) - Target: consistent increase in creator-led interactions.
- Poll and Q&A Response Volume - Target: 10% growth in audience interaction volume.
- User Generated Content (UGC) Growth - Target: 15% increase in participatory content within campaign period.

3. Sentiment & Community Metrics

- Positive Sentiment Score (comment analysis) - Target: noticeable improvement in positive to negative ratio.
- Repeat Engagement Rate - Target: 10–15% increase in recurring interaction behavior.

Gucci

- Engagement Volatility Index
- Campaign vs Non-Campaign Engagement Gap
- Weekly Engagement Consistency Score
  Success Indicator: Reduced engagement variance across content types

Versace

- Cultural Share Ratio (Shares ÷ Views)
- Comment Depth (Average words per comment)
- Creator Collaboration Impact Lift
  Success Indicator: Shift from transactional engagement to relational engagement

Strategy Justification

To improve Dior's engagement with Gen Z, two main initiatives were selected:

1. Creator Led Collaboration

This initiative helps Dior move away from a top down, broadcast style of communication. Gen Z prefers to participate, not just watch. By working with micro and nano creators who are active in fashion communities, Dior becomes more relatable and socially present.

Instead of depending only on large celebrity campaigns, this approach builds steady interaction through user-generated content and creator partnerships. This can increase engagement consistency and make the brand feel more connected to its audience.

2. Behind the Scenes Content Series

Dior's content is highly polished and visually strong, but it can feel distant. A behind the scenes series would show the creative process, craftsmanship, and real people behind the brand.

Gen Z values transparency and authenticity. Showing more human and process-based content can increase trust and emotional connection. This shifts engagement from simple admiration to meaningful interaction.

Strategic Impact

Together, these two initiatives help Dior become more participatory and authentic on social media. They aim to increase sustained engagement rather than short term spikes and build a stronger relationship with Gen Z audiences

Video Strategy & Links

This section evaluates recent short form video content from Dior and its competitors to assess alignment with Gen Z engagement behavior and strategic positioning.

Dior – Video 1

Platform: Instagram Reel

Link: https://www.instagram.com/reel/DUnX3XaDX5X/

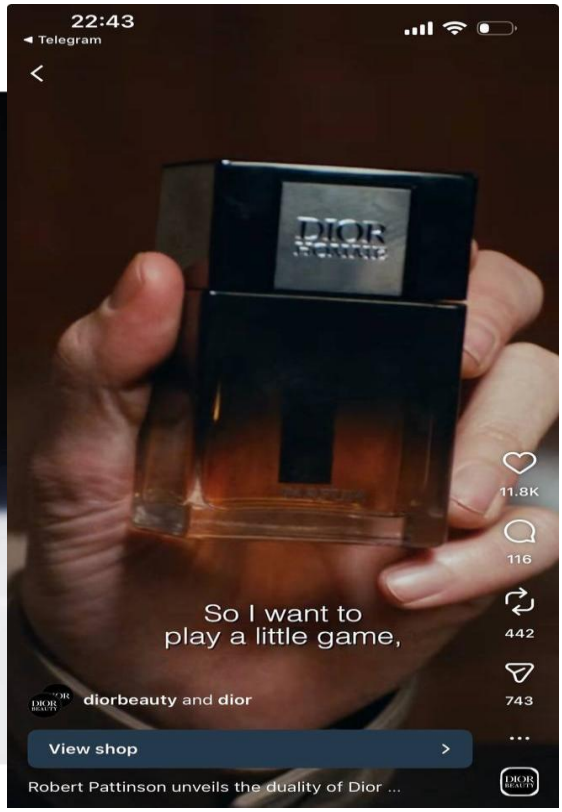
This reel from Dior's official Instagram account highlights stylish, short form content aligned with current Gen Z trends. The video's format is visually engaging and optimized for quick mobile consumption, which matches where Dior's target audience spends their time. While it emphasizes high-quality aesthetics, it also encourages short-form viewing behavior consistent with Gen Z's content preferences, supporting Dior's strategy to increase relevance on social platforms.

Dior – Video 2

Platform: Instagram Reel

Link: https://www.instagram.com/reel/DUd7Yi3DRwG/

This reel from Dior’s official Instagram demonstrates short-form storytelling that blends fashion visuals with trend-driven editing. The video’s format aligns with Gen Z’s preference for quick, ingestible content, encouraging repeated views and social sharing. Compared to static imagery, this dynamic format helps drive higher engagement and supports Dior’s strategic shift toward authentic, participatory content. By leveraging relatable creative formats, Dior moves closer to a tone that resonates with Gen Z audiences.



Gucci – Video 1

Platform: Instagram Reel

Link: https://www.instagram.com/reel/DUSjiI-jC3w/?igsh=MThqdmE3b2g2c21pOA==

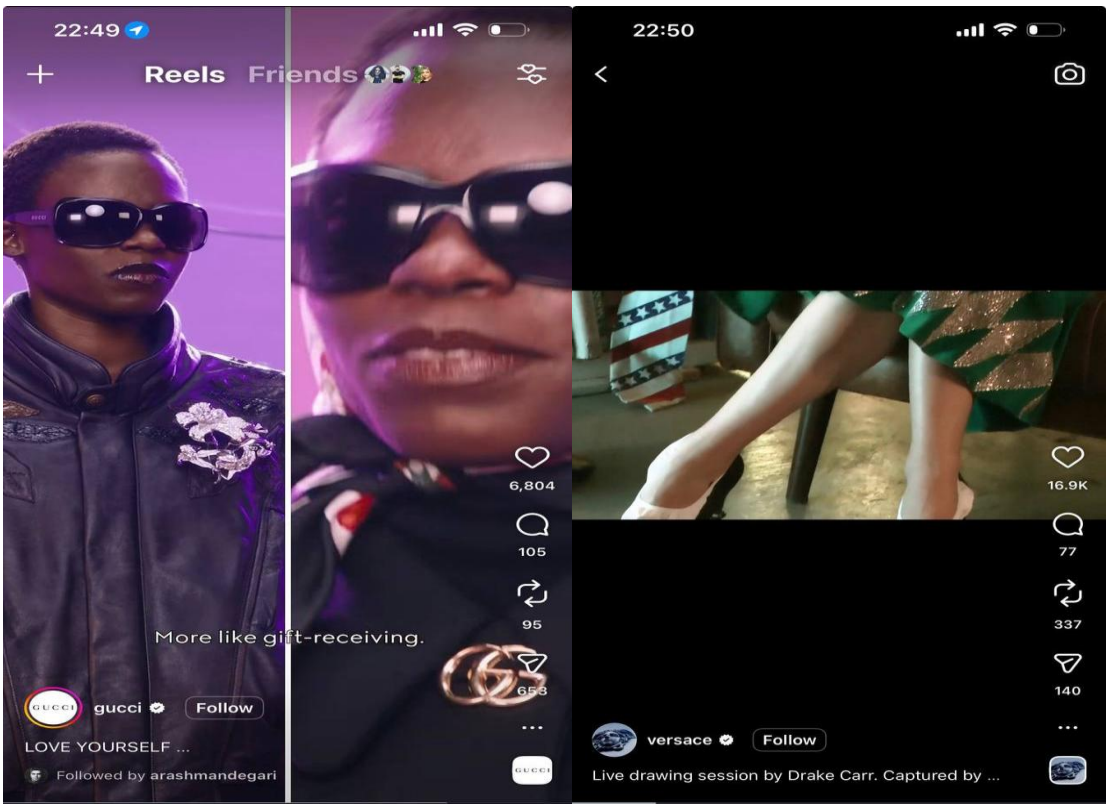
Analysis: Gucci leverages playful storytelling and bold visuals to capture attention. The content feels culturally aware and entertainment driven, which supports high initial engagement. However, performance often depends on campaign momentum rather than sustained community interaction.

Versace – Video 1

Platform: Instagram Reel

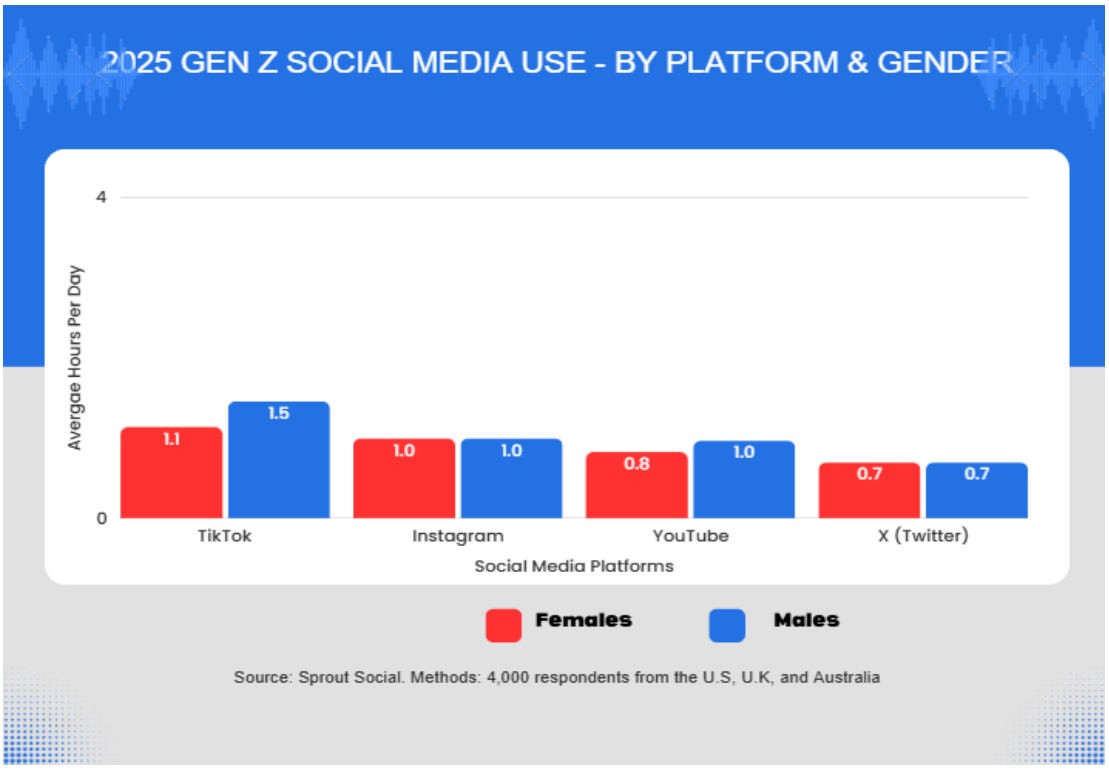
Link: https://www.instagram.com/reel/DTsyo74jCMl/

This reel highlights Versace's bold and visually strong aesthetic. While the content is engaging from a visual perspective, it focuses more on image presentation than audience participation. Compared to Dior's shift toward authenticity and interaction, this format appears more brand-centered than community driven.



Why Video is Critical for Gen Z

Short form video content on platforms such as Instagram Reels and TikTok significantly outperforms static imagery among Gen Z users. Younger audiences spend more time watching, sharing, and interacting with video-based content. Video enables storytelling, authenticity, and participatory features such as comments, shares, and remixing, making it essential for brands to build sustained engagement.



Engagement Improvement Plan

Strategic Objective

Based on the diagnostic findings in Step 1 and the KPI framework developed in Step 2, Dior's primary engagement challenge is not declining reach but declining participatory depth among Gen Z.

The objective of Step 3 is to:

- Increase participatory engagement
- Improve sentiment and trust signals
- Reduce engagement volatility
- Shift from broadcast authority to cultural collaboration

KPI Aligned Strategic Actions

1- Creator Collaboration with Gen Z

Problem Identified:

Dior's communication style feels one-way and authority driven. Gen Z watches the content, but they do not actively participate.

Strategic Action:

Dior should collaborate with micro and nano Gen Z creators such as fashion students, stylists, and digital artists. This will make the brand feel more relatable and socially connected instead of distant and formal.

KPIs Impacted:

- Engagement Rate (target: +10–15%)
- Increase in Duet/Stitch participation
- UGC growth (target: +15%)
- Repeat Engagement Rate (target: +10–15%)

Expected Business Impact:

- Stronger community connection
- More stable and consistent engagement
- Increased brand relatability among Gen Z

2 – Behind the Scenes Content Series (Inside Dior)

Problem Identified:

Dior's content is highly polished and visually perfect. While this supports luxury positioning, it can feel distant and less authentic to Gen Z audiences.

Strategic Action:

Dior should launch a recurring short form video series that shows:

- The creative process behind collections
- Craftsmanship and atelier work
- Designer commentary
- Real, imperfect, behind the scenes moments

This approach makes the brand feel more human and socially present.

KPIs Impacted:

- Increase in Comment to View Ratio
- Growth in Save Rate
- Improvement in Positive Sentiment Score

Expected Business Impact:

- Increased trust perception
- Stronger emotional connection with Gen Z
- More sustained engagement rather than short term spikes

3 - Interactive Social Features

Problem Identified:

Although Dior receives high views, much of the engagement is passive. Gen Z audiences watch the content but do not consistently interact with it.

Strategic Action:
Dior should introduce more interactive features on TikTok and Instagram, such as:

- Polls and Q&A sessions
- TikTok duet and stitch prompts
- Comment led content responses
- Remix friendly audio formats

These features encourage active participation instead of passive viewing.

KPIs Impacted:

- Increase in Participation Rate
- Growth in Poll and Q&A responses
- Higher Comment Depth
- Increase in User-Generated Content (UGC)

Expected Business Impact:

- Shift from passive admiration to active participation
- Stronger community involvement
- Higher long-term engagement consistency

Measurement and Dashboard Plan

Dior should implement a 6-month evaluation dashboard including:

1. Engagement Rate (weekly tracking)
2. Comment to View Ratio
3. Save Rate
4. UGC Volume
5. Sentiment Score (positive/negative ratio)
6. Engagement Volatility Index

Success will be defined as:

- 10–15% overall engagement growth
- Reduced campaign vs non campaign engagement gap
- Improved engagement consistency score

Conclusion

The engagement diagnostic confirms that Dior's challenge is not declining brand interest, but a misalignment between luxury authority positioning and Gen Z platform behavior. While Dior continues to command attention at scale, engagement increasingly concentrates around spectacle rather than sustained dialogue.

To restore participatory engagement, Dior must:

- Shift from broadcast to collaboration
- Replace perfection signaling with transparency
- Integrate platform native interaction mechanisms

By aligning content strategy with measurable KPIs and structured experimentation, Dior can:

- Increase engagement depth
- Strengthening trust signals
- Build sustained cultural relevance among Gen Z

Long term success will depend not on content volume or production polish, but on cultural fluency and relational participation.